Periodic Progress Report

Hikaya – AI-Powered Platform for Preserving Palestinian Memory and Heritage

Team Name: Beta

Report Date: 30/06/2026

Reporting Period: Previous Two Weeks

Team Members:
Aws Hammad – Birzeit University
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Amra Sawalha – Palestine Polytechnic University
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1. Project Summary

Project Title: Hikaya – AI-Powered Platform for Preserving Palestinian Memory and Heritage

Short Description:

Hikaya is an AI-powered interactive storytelling platform designed to preserve, document, and revive Palestinian history, culture, oral history, and collective memory. The platform allows users to explore historical and cultural locations across Palestine through an interactive map. When a user selects a location, the system presents historical information, simplified AI-generated narratives, multimedia content, and user-contributed stories.

The main goal of Hikaya is to transform static historical and cultural information into an engaging digital experience that supports cultural awareness, tourism, education, and the preservation of Palestinian identity.

2. Progress During This Reporting Period

During this reporting period, the team focused mainly on planning, organizing, and preparing the project for technical implementation. Due to the final exam period for most team members, technical development progress was limited. However, the team

worked on confirming the project direction, defining the MVP scope, preparing the role distribution, and planning the GitHub repository structure.

The main progress completed during this period includes:

- **Project Idea Finalization:** The team finalized the idea of Hikaya as an interactive platform for preserving Palestinian memory and heritage using maps, multimedia storytelling, and AI-assisted narrative generation.
- **Problem and Solution Definition:** The team clarified the main problem, which is the limited digital preservation of Palestinian heritage, fragmented historical information, and the risk of losing oral history and collective memory.
- **MVP Scope Definition:** The team agreed that the first version should focus on a limited number of selected Palestinian locations instead of trying to build a large national-scale platform from the beginning.
- **Initial Role Distribution:** The team prepared an initial distribution of responsibilities across project management, frontend, backend, database, AI features, content collection, QA, and documentation.
- **Technical Architecture Planning:** The team identified the main system components, including frontend, backend, database, AI module, location services, and media storage.
- **GitHub Repository Preparation:** The team started preparing the GitHub repository structure to organize documentation, frontend, backend, AI, database, and content files.
- **AI Component Improvement:** Based on mentor feedback, the AI component will be improved from simple story generation into a more meaningful AI Heritage Guide that uses reviewed content to generate simplified narratives and answer user questions.

3. Final Exams Impact

This reporting period overlapped with the final exam period for most team members. Because of this, the team was not able to move forward with full technical implementation as planned. Instead, the work during this period focused on preparation tasks such as planning, defining the project scope, organizing the team, preparing documentation, and setting up the GitHub repository.

The team plans to start stronger technical implementation after the final exam period, with all progress and updates documented through GitHub commits.

4. Updated MVP Plan

The first version of Hikaya will focus on demonstrating the core idea through a small but meaningful prototype.

MVP Features:

- Interactive map showing selected Palestinian historical and cultural locations
- Location details page for each selected place
- AI-generated simplified story based on reviewed content
- AI Heritage Guide that can answer simple questions about a selected location
- Multimedia support such as images and audio narration
- User contribution form for submitting memories, stories, or media
- Basic review process for user-submitted content

Initial Selected Locations:

- Old City of Jerusalem
- Bethlehem
- Sebastia

These locations may be updated based on content availability and mentor feedback.

5. Updated AI Direction

The AI component is an important part of Hikaya. However, based on feedback, the team will avoid making the AI limited to simple story generation only. The updated direction is to make the AI more integrated into the system.

Planned AI Features:

- **AI Story Generation:** Convert reviewed historical content into simplified and engaging narratives.
- **AI Heritage Guide:** Allow users to ask simple questions about a selected location and receive answers based on available reviewed content.
- **Story Personalization:** Generate different versions of the story depending on the target audience, such as students, tourists, children, or general users.
- **Contribution Analysis:** Help summarize user-submitted stories, suggest categories, and prepare them for human review.

Important AI Rule:

The AI should not invent historical facts. It should only simplify, rewrite, organize, and present reviewed historical and cultural content provided by the team.

6. Team Role Distribution

The initial role distribution is shown below. The distribution may be updated based on final confirmation from team members and availability after the final exam period.

Role	Team Member(s)	Responsibilities
Leader / Project Management	Aws Hammad	Coordination, planning, task distribution, GitHub follow-up, report preparation, and integration between team members.
Frontend Development	Amra Sawalha	Develop the web interface, interactive map page, location details page, story view, and contribution form.
Backend & Database	Noureddin Etkaidek, Doaa Hatu	Design and implement APIs, manage data flow, connect frontend with database, and prepare the database schema.
AI / Smart Features	Arwa Al-Hajahja, Hussein Jaradat	Build AI prompts or models for story generation, AI Heritage Guide, content simplification, and contribution analysis.
Content / QA / Documentation	Joud Abu Omar, Tamara Hamdan	Collect historical information, verify content accuracy, prepare sample locations, test user flow, and support documentation.

7. GitHub Repository Plan

The GitHub repository will be used to track all project updates, documentation, source code, and technical progress.

Planned Repository Name:

- Hikaya-AI-Heritage-Platform

Initial Repository Structure:

- `README.md`: General project description, MVP features, and technology stack

- `docs/`: Reports, MVP plan, system architecture, and team roles
- `frontend/`: Frontend source code and frontend documentation
- `backend/`: Backend source code and API documentation
- `ai/`: AI module planning and implementation files
- `database/`: Database schema and design files
- `content/`: Sample locations and historical content drafts

Initial GitHub Tasks:

- Create the main repository
- Add all confirmed team members as collaborators
- Upload the project README file
- Upload the MVP plan
- Upload the team role distribution
- Upload the first periodic report
- Prepare folders for frontend, backend, AI, database, and content work

8. Challenges and Risks

- **Final Exam Pressure:** Most team members were busy with final exams, which delayed technical implementation. **Mitigation:** The team will restart technical work after exams and will divide tasks into smaller GitHub-tracked updates.
- **Team Availability:** Some members are still confirming their availability and commitment. **Mitigation:** The team leader is collecting confirmations and GitHub usernames to finalize the active team members.
- **AI Accuracy:** AI-generated content may produce inaccurate historical information if not controlled. **Mitigation:** The AI will only use reviewed content and will not be allowed to invent facts.
- **Project Scope:** The full idea is large and may be difficult to complete within the competition timeframe. **Mitigation:** The MVP will focus only on a few selected locations and core features.

9. Plan for the Next Reporting Period

During the next reporting period, the team plans to move from planning into technical implementation.

Planned Tasks:

- Finalize active team members and GitHub collaborators
- Create frontend wireframes and basic page structure
- Implement the initial frontend layout
- Design the first database schema
- Create basic backend API structure
- Prepare sample historical content for selected locations
- Build the first version of the AI story generation workflow
- Define how the AI module will connect with the backend
- Continue updating the GitHub repository with regular commits

10. Conclusion

During this reporting period, the team focused on organizing the project, confirming the idea, defining the MVP, distributing responsibilities, and preparing the GitHub repository. Although final exams limited technical implementation progress, the project direction is now clearer, and the team is preparing to begin stronger implementation work in the next period.

The next major goal is to start building the first working prototype of Hikaya, beginning with the repository setup, frontend structure, backend planning, database schema, AI module plan, and initial content samples.